

The Capex Tax

Three companies beat earnings this week and were sold anyway. Alphabet, Intel and Texas Instruments each cleared the bar on revenue and profit, then raised what they intend to spend — and the market marked all three down. The buyers went where the spending lands: servers, memory, power. The sellers went where the spending comes from.

S&P 500 7,411.98 +0.05% Fri · -0.6% wk	NASDAQ COMP 24,975.82 -0.64% Fri · -2.0% wk	DOW JONES 51,947.25 +0.46% Fri · only index up	WTI CRUDE \$89.31 -3.1% Fri · +30% MTD	US 10-YEAR 4.67% high since Jan 2025	BITCOIN ~\$63.9k +9% in July
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Top 10 movers, up and down

bars share one scale, 0–90%

▲ Ten biggest advances	20–24 JUL
01 UTZ Utz Brands TUE 21 · Taken private by Intersnack Group in a \$2.9bn deal. The week's only true one-off — a closed-end event, not a trend.	+89.2%
02 SMCI Super Micro Computer TUE–WED · Over \$60bn of new Q4 orders, record backlog, and gross-margin guidance lifted from 8.2–8.4% to 15–17%. Plans an AI data centre with SpaceX.	+25.0%
03 ACHR Archer Aviation MON 20 · Defence-tech partnership; the single largest one-day move of Monday's session.	+22.0%
04 NBIS Nebius Group TUE 21 · Nvidia disclosed a 9.3% stake in the neocloud — ~22.3m shares, tracing to a \$2bn March investment. Analyst targets followed.	+18.9%
05 MU Micron Technology TUE 21 · Memory melt-up: WDC and STX each rose about the same, the DRAM ETF +11%. Round-tripped by Friday — see below.	+12.0%
06 COIN Coinbase TUE 21 · Bitcoin hit its highest since 16 June on CLARITY Act optimism and a fifth straight day of spot-ETF inflows.	+9.6%
07 WULF TeraWulf TUE 21 · Carried up in the same crypto-equity bid as COIN and HOOD.	+8.0%
08 NOW ServiceNow THU 23 · EPS \$0.90 vs \$0.85–0.86 est, subscription revenue +23%, FY guidance raised, AI ACV past \$1bn. A rare beat that was actually paid for.	+7.3%
09 HOOD Robinhood TUE 21 · Crypto-linked bid; closed at \$106.36.	+7.1%
10 HAS Hasbro TUE 21 · Q2 beat on both lines, FY adjusted EBITDA guidance raised.	+7.0%
JUST MISSED DPZ +7.0% (Mon, rose through an EPS miss) · EQT +6.6% (volume guidance raised) · HON +5% (FY outlook up) · CME +5% (best-ever first half) · AAPL +3.5% (Fri) · CRM +4.1%, IBM +3.6% (Fri, Dow leaders)	

▼ Ten biggest declines	20–24 JUL
01 LESL Leslie's WED 22 · Weighing Chapter 11. About \$757m of debt against \$61m FY25 adjusted EBITDA — roughly 12.5× leverage. Down over 99% since its 2020 IPO.	-47.0%
02 ACI Albertsons THU 23 · EPS \$0.42 vs \$0.54 est and FY26 guidance cut to \$1.75–1.85 from \$2.22–2.32. Identical sales flipped to a decline. Losing low-income shoppers to Walmart, Amazon and Aldi.	-22.0%
03 PEGA Pegasystems WED 22 · Q2 miss, slower contract growth, and a warning that AI-driven spending delays are hitting demand. The clearest "AI eats software" print of the week.	-16.7%
04 ROL Rollins WED 22 · EPS \$0.32 on \$1.08bn, both light, and the FY organic growth outlook cut on weak residential demand — despite a 99th straight quarter of revenue growth.	-14.7%
05 TSLA Tesla THU 23 · Worst earnings-reaction day on record. Record \$28.2bn revenue and 480,126 deliveries, but operating income fell 57%, margin hit 1.4%, FCF turned negative and capex heads past \$25bn. Down ~19% on the week.	-14.5%
06 SNDK SanDisk FRI 24 · Memory supply-glut fears as Samsung and SK Hynix add capacity. Still up ~526% YTD — this reads as profit-taking, not a broken thesis.	-11.0%
07 MOH Molina Healthcare THU 23 · Beat on EPS at \$1.51 but sold on falling membership and lower premium revenue. Health care is the only S&P sector shrinking this quarter.	-9.2%
08 WDC Western Digital FRI 24 · Same memory unwind; SK Hynix and Micron fell 6–8% alongside. Both ends of the round trip inside four sessions.	-9.0%
09 INTC Intel FRI 24 · Revenue \$16.1bn (+25%, fastest in 15 years), EPS \$0.42 versus \$0.21 est, data-centre and AI +59%. Popped 13% after hours, then gave it all back once capex above \$20bn landed.	-8.0%
10 GOOGL Alphabet THU 23 · Worst earnings reaction since Feb 2025. Revenue \$119.8bn (+24%), Cloud +82%, 12th straight double-digit quarter — erased by FY capex guided to \$195–205bn and a warning that 2027 goes higher still.	-7.1%
JUST MISSED GEV -7% (beat and raised, sold anyway) · RHI -6% · TXN -5.3% (double beat, priced for more) · SPCX -5.3% to a record low · CAVA -5% · AMZN -4%, MSFT -2% (Thu)	

One name, both lists

Micron and Western Digital appear on opposite boards in the same week. Both rose about 12% on Tuesday as memory pricing ran, then fell 6–9% on Friday when Samsung and SK Hynix capacity additions revived glut fears. That round trip — not the Tesla headline — is the week's cleanest read on how thin the AI-hardware bid actually is: it is a positioning trade, and it unwinds in a session.

Backdrop

what set the tone

THE CAPEX VERDICT Alphabet lifted FY26 capex to \$195-205bn (Q2 alone \$44.9bn, +101% y/y). Intel went past \$20bn . Tesla past \$25bn . All three beat; all three fell. Hyperscaler capex is tracking above \$500bn for 2026.	OIL AND THE GULF Brent settled above \$100 Thursday, +7% to \$100.69 and the highest since 22 May, after Houthi drone and missile strikes on two Saudi tankers. It slid to about \$95 Friday on US–Iran talk hopes. Crude is up ~30% this month.	RATES ARE THE OTHER TAX The 10-year sits at 4.67% , touching ~4.70% — the highest since January 2025. Funds rate 3.50-3.75% , with 2026 inflation projections revised up to 3.6% and Waller flagging risk tilted toward inflation.
EARNINGS, FLATTERED Q2 blended S&P growth jumped to 37.9% from 24.8% a week earlier — but Alphabet's GAAP figure carried a \$98bn one-off gain. Strip it out and the number is 25.9% . Ten of eleven sectors are growing; health care is the exception.	UNDER THE SURFACE Tech fell 2.37% Friday while real estate, financials, materials, health care and staples rose — 17 S&P names hit 52-week highs, led by JPMorgan. Communication services and consumer discretionary each shed roughly 6% on the week.	NEXT WEEK DECIDES IT FOMC 28-29 Jul , no dot plot, Chair Warsh at 2:30pm ET — a hold is expected but markets price roughly 35% odds of a hike. Then Microsoft, Meta, Amazon, Apple and Qualcomm all report into the same capex question.

Retail & social layer

REDDIT — HELD SEPARATE

This block is deliberately walled off from everything above. It is **chatter volume and vendor-computed sentiment**, not price or fundamental data, and it is not a source for any figure on the boards. Mention counts come from third-party scrapers polling r/wallstreetbets on short intervals, so rankings shift intraday and no two vendors agree exactly. Read it as a crowding indicator only.

MOST DISCUSSED INTC The week's runaway topic. Mention volume spiked +591% to +751% in 24 hours depending on the snapshot, on the Q2 beat and the capex reversal. volume spike · direction mixed	MOST BEARISH TSLA Sentiment tracked 24-36 of 100 after the print, with the 30-day score around 28 — firmly bearish. Cited: deliveries, margin collapse, executive departures, BYD charging. sentiment 28/100 · bearish	BULLISH CLUSTER GOOG · NVDA · AMD Flagged bullish with strong AI scores even as GOOGL fell 7.1% on the tape — a clean case of the crowd and the price disagreeing. bullish · diverges from price	ALSO TRENDING IBM · NOW Rounded out the top five most-talked-about names of 20-24 Jul across r/wallstreetbets and X, both on earnings. earnings-driven
Worth noting: the four names retail talked about most — INTC, TSLA, GOOGL, IBM — include three of the ten biggest decliners. Attention concentrated almost entirely on what was falling, and none of the week's actual top advances (UTZ, SMCI, ACHR, NBIS) registered in the top five by mention volume.			

How to read this. Moves are the **single-session reaction** to the catalyst named in each row, not full week-over-week returns, because that is how the underlying coverage reports them; the date chip on each row tells you which session. Where a figure was quoted intraday, after hours and at the close, the close is used and the others noted. A few percentages differ by one to two points between outlets covering the same move (SMCI was reported at +13%, +15%, +18% and +25% across venues and sessions) — the most widely corroborated figure is shown. Bars are scaled to a shared 0–90% range across both boards, so the two sides are directly comparable. Green and red never carry meaning alone: every value keeps its sign and every row sits in a labelled board. Compiled Saturday 25 July 2026 from the sources below; nothing here is investment advice.

SOURCES — 50 TOTAL, REDDIT AND SOCIAL LISTED SEPARATELY

INDICES, SESSIONS & WEEKLY WRAP (1–11)	SINGLE NAMES & EARNINGS (20–39)	SEMIS, MEMORY, APPLE & MACRO (40–50)
1. Motley Fool — Stock Market Today, July 24 2. Motley Fool — MIDDAY, July 24 3. TheStreet — Market Today, July 24 4. CNBC — Market news, July 24 5. Yahoo Finance — Friday live blog 6. Trading Economics — US index 7. Vantage — S&P 500, July 24 8. Investrade — Market Review, July 24 9. Investrade — Mid-Morning Look 10. Trefis — 17 S&P 52-week highs 11. Bloomberg — Futures steady, oil below \$100	20. CNBC — Tesla Q2 2026 21. Electrek — Tesla sheds \$140bn 22. Teslarati — Tesla Q2 results 23. CNBC — Alphabet Q2 takeaways 24. Investing.com — Alphabet call transcript 25. CNBC — Intel Q2 2026 26. Yahoo — Intel falls 8% on a beat 27. CNBC — IBM Q2 2026 28. ServiceNow — Q2 results release 29. Investing.com — ServiceNow transcript 30. CNBC — Super Micro surges 15% 31. Yahoo — SMCI \$60bn backlog 32. FXLeaders — SMCI margin reset 33. CNBC — Nebius +19% on Nvidia stake 34. Bloomberg — Leslie's weighs Chapter 11 35. Seeking Alpha — Leslie's sinks 36. CNBC — Albertsons plunges 37. TheStreet — Albertsons -22% 38. Benzinga — Rollins downbeat Q2 39. Benzinga — Molina membership decline	40. 24/7 Wall St — Memory selloff 41. Motley Fool — Why SanDisk dropped 42. Benzinga — TXN slips on a double beat 43. Motley Fool — Why Apple is up 44. TipRanks — Apple upgrades 45. FactSet — Earnings update, Jul 24 46. CNN — Oil tops \$100, Red Sea 47. CNBC — Oil after tanker attacks 48. Federal Reserve — H.15 rates 49. CNBC — Week ahead, Jul 27–31 50. Seeking Alpha — Catalyst watch, FOMC
DAILY MOVERS LISTS (12–19)		REDDIT & SOCIAL — SEPARATE, NOT USED FOR ANY PRICE FIGURE (R1–R8)
12. CNBC — MIDDAY movers, Jul 24 13. CNBC — Premarket movers, Jul 24 14. CNBC — MIDDAY movers, Jul 23 15. CNBC — MIDDAY movers, Jul 22 16. CNBC — MIDDAY movers, Jul 21 17. CNBC — Premarket movers, Jul 21 18. CNBC — MIDDAY movers, Jul 20 19. CNBC — Premarket movers, Jul 20		R1. Benzinga — 5 most-discussed, Jul 20–24 R2. AltIndex — r/wallstreetbets mentions R3. AltIndex — Reddit trending stocks R4. Tradestie — WSB most active R5. ApeWisdom — WSB trending R6. Sirius Investors — Reddit sentiment R7. 24/7 Wall St — Reddit bearish on Tesla R8. Stocktwits — SMCI backlog chatter